



Gigabyte G1.Sniper A88X

A new line of AMD FM2+ motherboards was launched by Gigabyte in anticipation of Kaveri.

Backdoor to Windows?

German government denies allegations that the "Trusted Computing" chip is in fact a 'back door' to Windows

Hedged-In

As cyberattacks grow in frequency and intensity governmental bodies show grit, Twitter urges for transparency and MTNL hits a minor snag

India must be more serious about cyber security: EC-Council

EC-Council has called for more stringent actions to secure cyber infrastructure in India. Citing the recent spate of cyberattacks on the websites of the Indian government, EC-Council has expressed concerns over the lack of professionals in the cyber security domain. It has suggested that the country should invest more into training young IT professionals as well as into creating a sturdy infrastructure for robust cyber defence.

At an event held in New Delhi, EC-Council Global President Jay Bavisi pointed out that China is estimated to have 25 million cyber security experts while 1.25 lakh are from the local government. The US has 91,080 experts in the government while India has just 556 experts. Bavisi also emphasized on the successful model of the US Cyber Security Plan, which envisages 15% more cyber security experts every year.

EC-Council pointed out a recent study revealing that 5.39 million local malware threats were detected on computers in India. According to the organisation, India is lagging behind in its fight against cyber warfare. Any attack will result in financial loss, no matter how sophisticated.

In regards to the government's Cyber Security Policy 2013, Jay Bavisi said the policy seemed to be great on paper, but there should be greater focus on its implementation. He was

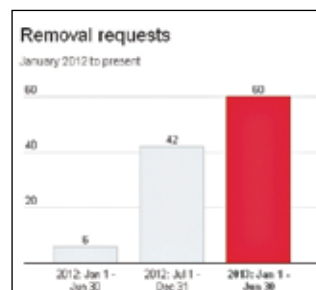


also sceptical about the government's target of creating a workforce of 5,00,000 professionals skilled in cyber security in the near future.

Relevantly, as many as 78 government websites fell prey to hackers in the first half of 2013, revealed Minister of State for Communications & IT Milind Deora in the Parliament.

Government requests to share user info on the rise: Twitter

Twitter has released its latest transparency report (January 1 - June 30, 2013), showing a significant 40% surge in the number of requests to release users' private information. The US tops the list with 1,157 requests for information about users – a 15% surge from the last transparency report.



Twitter also saw an increase in the number of withholdings, including the withholding of content in five new countries: Brazil, India, Japan, the Netherlands and Russia.

"An important conversation has begun about the extent to which companies should be allowed to publish information regarding national security requests. We have joined forces with industry peers and civil liberty groups to insist that the United States government allow for increased transparency into these secret orders," said Twitter in a blog post.

"We believe it's important to be able to publish numbers of national security requests – including FISA disclosures – separately from non-secret requests. Unfortunately, we are still not able to include such metrics."

MTNL Mumbai website hacked by Pakistani hacker

State-run telco MTNL's Mumbai website was allegedly hacked in August by a Pakistani hacker operating from Australia. The website was restored

soon after the attack, though some users complained about facing problems in accessing the site. An MTNL spokesperson said that this was due to the hacked homepage still being in the customers' caches and not refreshed.

MTNL's compromised website showed the following message: "MrCreepy Was Here. Napsters CrEw. Happy Independence Day Pakistan. <http://Facebook.com/m3creepy>. Greetings: SEEKER, Dr.FREAK, MKHAN SWATI, And All Pakistani Hackers :D".

Other MTNL websites including the corporate website remained unaffected. The hacker claimed on its Facebook page that it had also attacked the websites of Pune Traffic Police and janwani.org (a voluntary group). Both these websites were however found to be operational.

In June last year, MTNL's corporate website was disrupted by hacker group Anonymous to protest against censorship of the internet. Late last year the website of another state-run telecom operator BSNL was also hacked by Anonymous India.